

president Charles William Eliot became the university's first president to visit South Asia. Harvard professor John Kenneth Galbraith was asked by president John F. Kennedy to serve as US ambassador to India. In 1966, 66 Indian students were enrolled in Harvard and in 1987 Harvard president Derek Bok took a three-month sabbatical to travel to India. In 2003, Bose started the South Asia initiative and three years later, Harvard's controversial former president Larry Summers set the stage for greater involvement during a trip to India when he said, "Every American should visit the country that may be our most important ally two decades from now."

But for the first time, Harvard's love affair with India has gone beyond Sanskrit and Indian studies to include sociology, economics and government. The effort is multi-disciplinary, as opposed to the loose agglomeration of interests earlier, in keeping with Faust's principle of one university. As she says, "Accountability to the future requires that Harvard increasingly leap geographic as well as intellectual boundaries; and just as we live in a time of narrowing distances between fields and disciplines, so we inhabit an increasingly transnational world in which knowledge itself is the most powerful connector."

So at the Harvard Graduate School of Design (GSD), Niall Kirkwood, professor and chair of the department of landscape architecture, taught a studio course in 2006 in which students considered the fate of 600 acres of land at the centre of Mumbai occupied by 58 abandoned mills built more than 150 years ago. The 12 students travelled to India for field visits, meetings with stakeholders, and to study the city environment. Back in Cambridge, they prepared design proposals for adapting the mill district for present-day use. This year, Kirkwood and GSD faculty member Nazneen Cooper, are teaching another studio course called "Mumbai Margins: Rethinking the Island City". They are not alone in their focus. Jennifer Leaning, professor of practice of international health in the faculty of public health and a member of the SAI steering committee, has been involved in a number of

WINNING OVER INDIA

START a South Asia Initiative office in India to facilitate travel by Harvard scholars and students, support research in South Asia undertaken by Harvard scholars, and otherwise serve as the university's in-region presence.

CONTINUE the Kennedy School of Government's three-year executive education programme for senior IAS, members developed in collaboration with IIM-A and expected to train 360 senior officers.

ENCOURAGE the Harvard Design School to continue its year-long redevelopment effort in Mumbai.

PROPEL the HBS-funded India Research Centre to contribute to over 40 research projects and cases about Indian corporations.

CARRY forward the Harvard School of Public Health co-founded initiative to

The cross-disciplinary initiative recognises India's importance

fight diseases, the Public Health Foundation of India, which was launched last year. Its goal is to establish at least five world-class Indian institutes of public health over time, with the first two opening their doors by 2008.

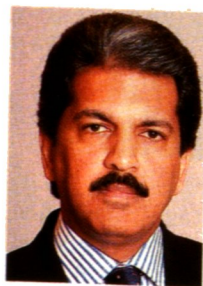
BEGIN the search for the first incumbent of a new \$4 million Harvard chair, funded almost entirely by alumni, Goldman Sachs MD Sanjeev Mehra and his wife Karen Peterson Mehra.



NEAL HAMBERG

"WHEN A UNIVERSITY LIKE HARVARD FOCUSES ON INDIA, IT HAS A BANDWAGON EFFECT."

ANAND MAHINDRA, VC AND MD, M&M



"ALL HARVARD SCHOOLS ARE WORKING TOGETHER FOR THE FIRST TIME, SIGNIFICANTLY IN INDIA."

VIKRAM GANDHI, MD, CREDIT SUISSE

HOSTING INDIA: Chidambaram delivering a lecture at HBS

projects related to South Asia, including a study of the demographic and humanitarian consequences of the Partition of India in 1947.

So is Harvard interested in India because of the money it earns from students? Not quite, says the faculty, pointing to 148 of the 193 students admitted last year receiving financial aid. Says Khanna, "There is a perception, perhaps rightly so, that the interest in India of some American universities is at least partially driven by tuition needs. We can assure you this is not the case at Harvard." Then, is it to make sure students graduating from here know more about Asian Indians than Cleveland Indians? Victor J. Menezes, vice-chairman of the Asia Society, retired senior vice-chairman of Citigroup and member of the Founders Club, says India is the flavour of the decade, "There is an increasing realisation that India is a microcosm of all that confronts the modern world, whether it is Islam, democracy, nuclear power or climate control." What ails India today could cure the world tomorrow. ■